

WHOSE GOD IS IT ANYWAY?

A purification ceremony at the Guruvayur temple has the state Government pushing to change ancient temple rituals and customs even as some groups lash out at the ruling CPI(M) for 'targeting' only Hindu places of worship

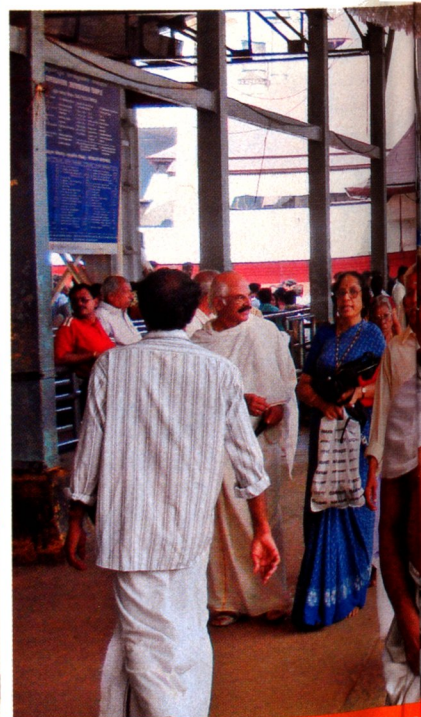
■ By M.G. Radhakrishnan

For millions of the faithful, no trip to Kerala is complete without a visit to the 16th century Sri Krishna temple at Guruvayur, 80 km from Cochin. Devoted to Lord Krishna, the temple is also known as the "Dwarka of the South".

However, these days the temple is not in the news for the faithful flocking to it. Exactly 75 years after the legendary Guruvayur Satyagraha was held to protest the ban on Dalits entering the famed temple, the shrine is now witness to another movement that seeks



RITUAL ROW: Ravi's ceremonial feeding was the latest flashpoint



The Guruvayur temple purification issue is threatening to acquire caste dimensions with